

Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A T 6

♥ A 7 4

♦ K Q T 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ 8 5 3

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 1
[show NS] NORTH has a perfect 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows that the most points the partnership could hold is 24 (7 + 17). Since this is below the 26 point game requirement he passes.

Board 2
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ T 9 7

♥ A 9 6

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ K 8 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A Q 4

♥ K T 8

♦ J T 9 5

♣ A Q 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass 3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 2
[show NS] SOUTH has an ideal 1NT opening - 16 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, NORTH knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game but not enough to think about slam. Since NORTH also has a balanced hand she bids 3NT.

Board 3
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q 8 2

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 9 4

♣ A 6 5

♠ A J 3

♥ A 8 7

♦ Q J T 5

♣ Q T 7

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass 3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 3
[show NS] NORTH has 16 points and balanced distribution. She naturally opens 1NT.

SOUTH has 14 points and balanced distribution so he does the math. The partnership has at least 29 points (14 + 15). The partnership has at most 31 points (14 + 17).

Since this is more than the 26 needed for game, but fewer than the 33 needed for slam SOUTH just bids 3NT, knowing NORTH will respect his decision and pass.

Board 4
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K 5 2
♥ 8 7 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ 7 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 9 6
♥ A J 5
♦ A Q J
♣ A 9 3 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT

All Pass
1NT by South

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 4
[show NS] When SOUTH opens 1NT, NORTH knows that he cannot have more than 17 points. So with her 7 points, she knows there is no reason to respond.

Board 5
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q J
♥ Q J 9 5
♦ A J 8
♣ Q J T

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ T 8 6 3
♥ K 4 2
♦ K 4 3
♣ K 7 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		

All Pass
3NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 5
[show NS] NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener. SOUTH has 9 points: - if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game. - if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game. Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she accepts the invitation.

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -	♠ T 8 4	♠ -									
♥ -	♥ K 7 2	♥ -									
♦ -	♦ Q 6 5	♦ -									
♣ -	♣ K J 9 3	♣ -									
	<table><tr><td></td><td>N</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>W</td><td></td><td>E</td></tr><tr><td></td><td>S</td><td></td></tr></table>		N		W		E		S		
	N										
W		E									
	S										
	♠ A 9 7 6										
	♥ A Q 4										
	♦ A J 4										
	♣ Q T 8										

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass 3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 6

[show NS] With 9 points NORTH is unable to decide the final contract. If SOUTH has 17 points then the partnership should be playing 3NT. If SOUTH opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So NORTH makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells SOUTH that he must make the final call - go on to game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal SOUTH has 17 points so he bids 3NT.

Board 7

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A T 6
♥ K 9 8
♦ A J 2
♣ K T 9 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q 4 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ T 8 4
♣ 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
All Pass 2NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 7

[show NS] This time NORTH has a minimum 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 9 points; he knows that the partnership is somewhere between 24 (9 + 15) and 26 (9 + 17). So he invites with a 2NT bid.

NORTH, with a minimum, declines the invitation by passing.

Board 8
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ J 7 4 2

♥ 8 5

♦ J 4 2

♣ 9 8 7 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q 6

♥ A J T 3

♦ A Q

♣ K J 5 2

West	North	East	South
			2NT
All Pass			
2NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 8
[show NS] SOUTH has a strong hand, 20 points and balanced distribution. It is just right to open 2NT (20-21 points).

NORTH adds her 2 points to SOUTH's promised number of 20 or 21. Since she doesn't reach the magic game number of 26 points she just passes.

Board 9
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A T 8
♥ A T 9
♦ K Q T 8
♣ K 9 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7 3
♥ Q 7 2
♦ J 9 4
♣ Q J T 8

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		

All Pass
3NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 9
[show NS] NORTH has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking NORTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But NORTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

Board 10
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ T 9 6 2

♥ K 7 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K Q J

♥ A 4

♦ K Q T 8

♣ A J 7 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		2NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 10
[show NS] SOUTH has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

NORTH has 8 points. She adds SOUTH's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and SOUTH passes.

Board 11
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ K 8 3

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A T 8

♥ K J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q J 7 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	4NT
All Pass 4NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 11
[show NS] NORTH has a low-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures the partnership holds either 31, 32 or 33. Obviously he wants to at least reach game, but if NORTH holds 17 points he wants to reach slam.

SOUTH bids 4NT. Since this is more than game it should be clear to NORTH that he is asking her to bid 6NT if she is at the top of her range. It is clear to NORTH, but with just 15 points she passes.

Board 12

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -



♣ -

♠ T 8 4

♥ Q 7 6

♦ K J 3

♣ K T 5 2



♠ —



♣ -

♠ A Q 5

♥ K 8 5

♦ Q T 7 6

♣ A 9 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

All Pass
2NT by South

1NT

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 12

[show NS] SOUTH has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

NORTH has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid. So she says 2NT.

Since SOUTH is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.

Board 13
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ Q J 4
♥ A K
♦ K 7 6
♣ Q J T 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K T 5
♥ Q 6 3
♦ A Q 5 4
♣ A K 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass 6NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 13
[show NS] NORTH has 17 points, counting 1 for the fifth Club. She has a balanced distribution so she opens 1NT.

SOUTH is also balanced, so he does the math.
NORTH has either 15, 16 or 17, and with SOUTH's 18 the partnership total is either 33, 34 or 35. That is enough for a small slam, but below the 37 points needed for Grand Slam so he bids 6NT.

Board 14
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -
♥ -
♦ -
♣ -

♠ K 7 4
♥ Q J 5
♦ K J T
♣ A 7 4 3

N

W E

S

♠ Q J 9
♥ A K 8
♦ A Q 5 3
♣ K Q 8

♠ -
♥ -
♦ -
♣ -

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		2NT
All Pass 6NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 14
[show NS] The partner who is first sure what the final contract should be should just go ahead and bid it. This is called "She who knows, goes."

In this deal, for example, it is NORTH who knows. She has a balanced 14 points, so when SOUTH indicates 20/21 points with his opening 2NT bid she KNOWS the partnership holds about 34/35 points.

Therefore she GOES to 6NT.

Board 15
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A T 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ K Q J T

♣ K J 7

♠ 8 5 3

♥ K 9 6

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ 9 6 5

N

W E

S

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass
3NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 15
[show NS] NORTH has a balanced 20 point hand - ideal to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows the partnership has either 27 or 28 points so he bids 3NT.

Board 16

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ 7 6 4
♥ A K 8
♦ K Q
♣ A J T 7 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 5
♥ T 7 4 3
♦ A 9 8 2
♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 16

[show NS] This is another example of "She who knows, goes."

NORTH has a solid 18 points, (1 extra for the fifth Club), so when SOUTH opens 1NT she KNOWS that together they must hold at least 33 points. They may even have 35 points.

In any case they should be in slam, so NORTH GOES to 6NT.

Board 17

West Deals

None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K J 9

♥ A Q

♦ K Q J 9 5

♣ K T 4

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ T 6 3

♥ T 8 5

♦ A 7 3

♣ Q 9 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 17

[show NS] NORTH has 20 points, counting one extra for the fifth Diamond. Just right to open 2NT.

SOUTH has 6 points, just enough to bid 3NT. (20 + 6 = 26) (21 + 6 = 27)

Board 18

South Deals

None Vul

♠	-	♠	-
♥	-	♥	-
♦	-	♦	-
♣	-	♣	-

♠ K J 9 2

♥ A 9 8

♦ Q T 8

♣ K Q J

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q T 3

♥ K T 6

♦ A 9 4

♣ T 7 5 2

West	North	East	South
			Pass
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 18

[show NS] After SOUTH passes initially, NORTH opens 1NT.

With 9 points, SOUTH has invitational strength, so he says 2NT.

NORTH has a small problem - SOUTH's bid tells her to bid 3NT with 17 points, but to pass with 15 points. Her problem is that she has 16! Since it looks to her like a "good" 16 points she bids 3NT. If those 10's and 9's had been 4's and 3's she would have passed.

Board 19
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K Q 9 3
♥ K Q T
♦ A J 7
♣ Q T 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 7
♥ A 8 4
♦ K T 6
♣ K J 7 4 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		

All Pass
6NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 19
[show NS] NORTH has a great 1NT hand - 17 points and 4-3-3-3 shape.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures it is possible that NORTH can make a slam, but only if she has a 17 point opener. So he bids 4NT, expecting NORTH to bid 6NT if she has 17 points but to pass if she has fewer.

He figured right - NORTH had 17 points so she bid 6NT.

Board 20
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K 8

♥ A K 5

♦ A 8

♣ Q T 9 6 3 2

♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 9 6

♦ K Q 5 2

♣ K J 8

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 20
[show NS] NORTH definitely does NOT have a balanced hand. She has two doubletons and a 6-card Club suit.

But she DOES have 18 points, (two extra for the fifth and sixth Clubs), and her 18 added to SOUTH's minimum of 15 is enough to bid 6NT.

Notice how easy this will be to play once that Club suit is established.

West	North	East	South
Pass	6NT		1NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			

Board 21
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ Q J T

♥ A J 7

♦ A K 6 2

♣ K Q J

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K 8 3

♥ 9 6 5 2

♦ 7 4 3

♣ 8 5 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			
2NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 21
[show NS] With 21 points and 4-3-3-3 distribution,
NORTH opens 2NT.

SOUTH has just 3 points; he knows that NORTH
cannot have more than 21 so the partnership total
cannot be more than 24. So he just passes 2NT.

Board 22
 South Deals
 None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ K 5 3
 ♥ K 5 3
 ♦ K 5 3
 ♣ K 7 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 4 2
 ♥ A 4 2
 ♦ A 6 4 2
 ♣ A 4 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass 3NT by South			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 22
 [show NS] This is an easy one to bid.

SOUTH has a balanced 16 points so he opens 1NT.

NORTH has a balanced 12 points so she responds 3NT.

BUT - just look at how this would play. You might only be able to take 8 tricks. Sometimes correct bidding gets you to unmakeable contracts. But it's only a game.

Board 23
West Deals
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ A J 5

♥ Q T 9 3

♦ K Q J

♣ A K 6

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ K 7 2

♥ K J 5

♦ A 7 4 2

♣ Q J 8

West	North	East	South
Pass	2NT	Pass	6NT

All Pass
6NT by North

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 23
[show NS] Notrump bidding really is easy, you just add your points to partner's points and then bid according to that answer.

Here SOUTH has 14 points. So when NORTH opens 2NT, showing 20 or 21 points SOUTH knows the total will come to 34 or 35 so he bids 6NT.

Board 24
South Deals
None Vul

♠ -		♠ -
♥ -		♥ -
♦ -		♦ -
♣ -		♣ -

♠ A K 6
♥ K 9 3
♦ K 7 4 3
♣ A 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 7 5
♥ Q 8 4
♦ Q 6 2
♣ Q 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT		Pass
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Baker Partnership-BasicNotrump 24
[show NS] SOUTH cannot open with only 8 points.

Furthermore, when NORTH opens 1NT SOUTH knows that the partnership has a 25 points at most so he passes again.